

# KIHWAN YU



## CONTACT INFORMATION

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|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Office</b> | Waters 331H, 1603 Old Claflin Pl<br>Manhattan, KS 66506, USA | <b>Email</b>   | <a href="mailto:kihwanyu@ksu.edu">kihwanyu@ksu.edu</a>                |
|               |                                                              | <b>Website</b> | <a href="https://kihwan-yu.github.io">https://kihwan-yu.github.io</a> |

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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Agricultural and Environmental Policy, Agricultural Production and Risk Management, Agricultural Finance

## EDUCATION

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| <b>Kansas State University</b><br>Ph.D. in Agricultural Economics                                | Kansas, USA<br>Expected December 2026 |
| <b>Seoul National University</b><br>M.A. in Agricultural and Resource Economics                  | South Korea<br>2019                   |
| <b>Kangwon National University</b><br>B.A. in Agricultural and Resource Economics and Psychology | South Korea<br>2017                   |

## JOB MARKET PAPER

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### **"The supply of offers and bids in the Conservation Reserve Program"**

Kihwan Yu, Nazli Z. Uludere Aragon, and Nathan P. Hendricks

*Abstract:* A central challenge in payments for ecosystem services (PES) is designing mechanisms that procure environmental benefits cost-effectively. While many PES programs use auction mechanisms with reference prices to reduce information rents, existing evidence provides limited guidance on how these prices affect participants' bidding behavior and enrollment decisions. We examine CRP General Signup offers using two sources of exogenous variation generated by administrative policy changes. We find that landowners respond to higher reference prices by offering higher rental rates, but the effects on offered acres are more mixed, suggesting that higher reference prices have limited effects on land-use decisions.

## WORKING PAPERS

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### **"Resource-Driven Agricultural Clusters: Coagglomeration Effects of the High Plains Aquifer"**

(Second-round revision submitted, American Journal of Agricultural Economics)

Kihwan Yu and Nathan P. Hendricks

*Abstract:* Quantifying the regional economic impacts of crop production is critical for assessing the broader implications of access to natural resources and government policies. However, most existing estimates rely on input-output models with restrictive assumptions and competing theories of economic mechanisms provide little guidance on the sign or magnitude. We estimate local economic spillovers by exploiting a large increase in crop production that occurred due to the expansion of irrigation in counties overlying the High Plains Aquifer after World War II. While crop production was directly impacted by access to groundwater, we find that livestock product sales also increased significantly, reaching a 235% increase in sales compared to counties outside the aquifer. The primary spillover to non-farm sectors was an increase in sales in the wholesale sector, perhaps driven by sales of agricultural-related products. These findings provide evidence of coagglomeration incentives, where clusters of agricultural industries find it optimal to produce within the same region.

## WORK IN PROGRESS

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### "Risk Aggregation and Insurance Demand: An Analysis of Enterprise Unit Discounts"

Kihwan Yu and Nathan P. Hendricks

## PUBLICATIONS

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Kim, Y. J., Jung, J., Yu, K., Kim, S., and Olynk Widmar, N. 2024. "Spatial differentiation in food service pricing: an explorative study with web-scraped data." *International Food and Agribusiness Management Review*, 27(3), 566–592.

### (Journal Articles in Korean)

K. Yu, D. Jeong, and K. Kim. 2021. "Estimating the Effects of Donation Tax Reduction on Farmland Using a Generalized Propensity Approach." *The Korean Journal of Agricultural Economics*, 62(1), 1–21.

K. Yu, and K. Kim. 2019. "An Estimation of Welfare Effects of Minimum Wage Increase in an Agricultural Production Sector Using a Stochastic Equilibrium Displacement Model." *The Korean Journal of Agricultural Economics*, 60(2), 1–21.

## AWARDS

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| Outstanding Article Award, Korean Agricultural Economics Association          | 2022 |
| Third Place Award, Paper Competition, Korean Rural Development Administration | 2018 |
| Outstanding Undergraduate Thesis Award, Kangwon National University           | 2016 |

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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### **Independent Instructor, Kansas State University**

AGEC 115 Decision Tools for Agricultural Economics and Agribusiness Fall 2024  
Average Evaluation: 4.6/5.0

### **Workshop Instructor, Kansas State University**

Introductory R Workshop for Incoming Students 2025, 2026

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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|--------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Graduate Research Assistant, Kansas State University   | 2023–Present |
| Researcher, Korea Rural Economic Institute             | 2020–2022    |
| Researcher, Seoul National University                  | 2019         |
| Graduate Research Assistant, Seoul National University | 2017–2018    |

## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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Presenter. "Local Economic Spillovers of Irrigation from the High Plains Aquifer to the Agricultural and Non-Agricultural Sectors." Annual Meeting of the Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA), New Orleans, LA, 2024.

Coauthor. "Spatial Differentiation in Pricing Strategy of Restaurant Business: An Explorative Study with Network Analysis Based on Web-Scraped Data from a Delivery Application." Annual Meeting of the Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA), Washington, DC, 2023.

Presenter. "Identifying the Impact of Emergency Disaster Relief Fund in Agri-Food Industry during the COVID-19 Pandemic in Korea: A Synthetic Control and Stochastic Equilibrium Displacement Method Approach." Annual Meeting of the Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA), Virtual, 2021.

Presenter. "Estimating the Effects of HMR Consumption Increase on Food Industry in Korea: A Stochastic Multi-sector and Multi-market Equilibrium Displacement Modelling Approach." Annual Meeting of the Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA), Virtual, 2020.

Presenter. "An Economic Evaluation of Climate Effects on Urban Flood Damages: The Case of Seoul, South Korea." Annual Meeting of the North American Regional Science Council (NARSC), Pittsburgh, PA, 2019.

## SERVICE & LEADERSHIP

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| Peer Academic Advisor for Undergraduate Students        | 2016 |
| President, Food System Research Society                 | 2015 |
| Student Social Committee Member, Agricultural Economics | 2014 |

## REFERENCES

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|                         |                                                                                        |                   |                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Nathan Hendricks</b> | Professor<br><a href="mailto:nph@ksu.edu">nph@ksu.edu</a><br>Kansas State University   | <b>Jesse Tack</b> | Professor<br><a href="mailto:jtack@ksu.edu">jtack@ksu.edu</a><br>Kansas State University                  |
| <b>Jennifer Ifft</b>    | Professor<br><a href="mailto:jiff@ksu.edu">jiff@ksu.edu</a><br>Kansas State University | <b>Jisang Yu</b>  | Associate Professor<br><a href="mailto:jisangyu@korea.ac.kr">jisangyu@korea.ac.kr</a><br>Korea University |